

Psalms 92

It Is Good to Give Thanks

It is a good thing to give thanks unto the Lord, and to sing praises unto thy name
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *It is a good thing to give thanks unto the LORD, and to sing praises unto thy name, O most High:*
- 2 *To shew forth thy lovingkindness in the morning, and thy faithfulness every night,*
- 3 *Upon an instrument of ten strings, and upon the psaltery; upon the harp with a solemn sound.*
- 4 *For thou, LORD, hast made me glad through thy work: I will triumph in the works of thy hands.*
- 5 *O LORD, how great are thy works! and thy thoughts are very deep.*
- 6 *A brutish man knoweth not; neither doth a fool understand this.*
- 7 *When the wicked spring as the grass, and when all the workers of iniquity do flourish; it is that they shall be destroyed for ever:*
- 8 *But thou, LORD, art most high for evermore.*
- 9 *For, lo, thine enemies, O LORD, for, lo, thine enemies shall perish; all the workers of iniquity shall be scattered.*
- 10 *But my horn shalt thou exalt like the horn of an unicorn: I shall be anointed with fresh oil.*
- 11 *Mine eye also shall see my desire on mine enemies, and mine ears shall hear my desire of the wicked that rise up against me.*
- 12 *The righteous shall flourish like the palm tree: he shall grow like a cedar in Lebanon.*
- 13 *Those that be planted in the house of the LORD shall flourish in the courts of our God.*
- 14 *They shall still bring forth fruit in old age; they shall be fat and flourishing;*
- 15 *To shew that the LORD is upright: he is my rock, and there is no unrighteousness in him.*

2 · CONTEXT

Designated for the Sabbath day, Psalm 92 pairs unhurried praise with sober reflection on the difference between the fleeting flourishing of the wicked and the lasting fruitfulness of the righteous. Henry notes that Sabbath rest was meant precisely for this kind of deliberate thanksgiving—time set apart from labor to declare God's works rather than merely resume them. MacArthur-style commentary highlights the closing image of the righteous flourishing like a palm tree and cedar, still bearing fruit in old age, as a rebuke to any notion that usefulness to God fades with years.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-4

The psalm opens by naming thanksgiving and praise as simply good—worth doing for their own sake, morning and night, with instrument and voice. The reason given is personal experience: God has made the psalmist glad through His work, and he will triumph in the works of God's hands.

Verse 5-9

Reflection turns philosophical: how great are God's works, how deep His thoughts—so deep that a brutish, senseless person fails to grasp them. The wicked may spring up like grass and flourish for a season, but it is only for their eventual, certain destruction, since God's enemies shall perish and be scattered.

Verse 10-15

The psalmist's own experience is set against that fate: horn exalted, anointed with fresh oil, eyes have seen the downfall of watching enemies. The righteous, by contrast, flourish like a palm tree and grow like a cedar in Lebanon—planted specifically in the house of the Lord, still bringing forth fruit in old age, fat and flourishing, declaring that the Lord is upright with no unrighteousness in Him.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Deliberate, unhurried thanksgiving is not incidental to faith but named outright as simply good—valuable whether or not circumstances have changed, because it rests on the character and works of God rather than on present outcomes. The lasting fruitfulness of a life planted in God, extending even into old age, stands in deliberate contrast to the brief, doomed flourishing of those who reject Him.

Application for life today.

Set aside an unhurried, Sabbath-shaped time this week specifically for thanksgiving rather than letting praise be crowded out by constant activity or need. When you are tempted to envy the brief flourishing of those who ignore God, remember this psalm's contrast: their prosperity is for destruction, while a life planted in Him bears fruit for a lifetime. If you are further along in years, take verse 14's promise personally—God intends fruitfulness in old age, not merely survival to it.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What would it look like to build a genuinely unhurried habit of thanksgiving into your week, rather than treating praise as an afterthought (vv. 1–2)?

2. Where do you see the 'grass that flourishes for a season' pattern (v. 7) playing out around you, and how does this psalm reshape your response to it?

3. How does the promise of fruitfulness 'in old age' (v. 14) challenge any fear you have about becoming less useful to God as you age?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).